Spark Center for Innovation in Learning
North American AI Challenge
An accelerated student design and venture challenge for inclusive excellence

Technical Code Review Checklist

Applicable to all teams

Each submission will undergo a technical review to ensure the repository reflects an authentic development process and a clear understanding of the work behind the final project. Reviewers will consider the project as a whole, including development history, code structure, documentation, use of external resources and AI tools, and alignment with the final demonstration.

TEAM NAME: _____

1. Repository should reflect authentic, collaborative, and iterative development throughout the challenge.

- ☐ Commits reflect meaningful iteration rather than unexplained bulk additions
- ☐ Repository shows evidence of team collaboration
- ☐ Repository history aligns with the final project

2. Code should be purposeful, original, and understood by your team.

- ☐ Code is logically structured and relevant to the project, with minimal unused, duplicated, or placeholder code
- ☐ Technical decisions demonstrate intentional development for the project
- ☐ Team members can explain key sections of their code and technical decisions
- ☐ No substantial unexplained reuse from prior projects, hackathons, or public repositories

3. Documentation should clearly explain the project and transparently identify external resources and AI assistance.

- ☐ Documentation clearly explains the project, its functionality, and how to use it
- ☐ Setup, dependencies, and technical requirements are documented
- ☐ Language is clear, concise, and specific to the project
- ☐ External or generated code and AI assistance is appropriately disclosed, integrated, and understood by the team

4. Final codebase should align with the demonstrated product, reflect consideration of the intended user, and follow basic security practices.

- ☐ Submitted code aligns with the functionality shown in the final demonstration
- ☐ Design and UX reflect consideration of the intended user
- ☐ No exposed API keys, secrets, credentials, or private data are committed

Reviewer feedback: